

Grade 7 ELA Curriculum Map: A Writing-Centered Year

McIntosh County School System | Georgia's K-12 ELA Standards (approved May 2023) | Georgia Milestones Grade 7 ELA Achievement Level Descriptors (draft, effective 2025-2026)

Built for a 7th grade ELA teacher whose instructional emphasis is writing. Every unit is driven by a writing standard and a summative writing task. Reading standards ride alongside as mentor and source texts, which is how the 2023 standards are built: every Texts standard has an Interpreting side and a Constructing side, and the Constructing side is the writing.

1. How to use this map

What this document does. It fixes the sequence, the priority standards, the summative task, and the success-criteria ladder for each unit. A unit plan (Stage 1, 2, 3) gets built from the unit's section here. Stage 1 copies the unit's priority standards. Stage 2 builds the summative named here first, then the formatives that mirror it. Stage 3 fills in the weekly arc.

Calendar assumptions. 36 instructional weeks in four 9-week grading periods, 180 days, five days per week. The Georgia Milestones EOG window is placed in weeks 34 and 35 (late April). If MCSS tests earlier, pull Unit 7 forward and shorten Unit 6 by one week. Nothing else moves.

Priority versus supporting standards. Each unit lists a short set of priority standards. Those go in Stage 1 and get assessed on the summative with three or more items or a rubric row each. Supporting standards are taught through routines and do not go in Stage 1. Keeping Stage 1 to six or seven standards is what makes a unit teachable and assessable. A Stage 1 with fifteen standards is a list, not a plan.

Standard codes. Codes follow the 2023 document: **7.T.T.3.c** is Texts domain, Techniques big idea, Argumentative standard, expectation c. **K-12.P.EICC.4** is the Practices domain writing-process standard. GUM codes (I, C, M, R) come from the Grammar, Usage, and Mechanics chart in the standards document and mean Introduce, Continue, Master, Reinforce at grade 7.

If the year is already underway. Drop in at the current week. Run the baseline writing this week if it has not happened. Hold the Unit 5 argument dates and the Unit 7 dates. The non-negotiables for the year are: an expository and an argumentative extended writing task in Georgia Milestones format before the EOG window, at least four timed essays scored with the Milestones rubric across the year, and section-level writing tasks in every unit.

2. Year at a glance

Unit	Weeks	Days	Writing mode	Summative writing task	Milestones connection	Grade 7 GUM focus
1. Launch: A Community of Writers	1 to 3	15	Process, paragraph, on-demand baseline	Baseline extended writing (Milestones format) plus writer's launch reflection	Baseline trait scores on the 3-trait rubric	Diagnostic of Reinforce items; sentence types; demonstrative pronouns (I, M)
2. Narrative Craft: Myths and Retellings	4 to 9	30	Narrative	Modern retelling of a myth (process) plus timed narrative constructed response	Narrative constructed response; theme comparison	Dialogue punctuation (R); verb tense consistency; participles and modifiers
3. Expository Writing from Sources	10 to 14	25	Expository	Extended expository essay from paired sources (Milestones format) plus field-guide article with text features	Extended writing task (expository); section-level tasks	Commas, parentheses, dashes for nonessential elements (M); semicolons in a series (R); colons (I)
4. Research, Credibility, and Multimodal Presentation	15 to 18	20	Research report, multimodal	Short research report with citations and works cited plus multimodal presentation; semester benchmark	Research and citation items; "draft research text" ALD language	Punctuation with citations (C); titles of works (R); active voice
5. Argumentative Writing from Sources	19 to 25	35	Argumentative	Extended argumentative essay from paired sources (Milestones format) plus real-audience argument	Extended writing task (argumentative); counterclaim items	Correlative conjunctions (R); subordinating conjunctions and introductory commas (R); semicolons with conjunctive adverbs (C)
6. Literary Analysis and Poetry	26 to 30	25	Analytical, poetic	Literary analysis essay comparing theme development plus poetry portfolio with writer's note	Theme comparison; fiction versus historical account; poetic techniques	Verbals: gerunds and infinitives (I); verb aspects (R); citation punctuation (C)
7. Milestones Writing Intensive	31 to 33	15	Mixed, on demand	Full mock EOG with trait scores; trait-based small groups	All tested writing item types	Review of every Reinforce and Master item
EOG window and Capstone	34 to 36	15	Multimodal, reflective	Capstone multimodal text plus portfolio reflection letter	Post-test	Grade 8 preview: colons with quotations, dashes, verb mood

3. The Georgia Milestones writing target

This section is what the ALDs actually say about writing at grade 7, translated into planning terms. Read it before building any Stage 2.

3.1 THE EXTENDED WRITING TASK

The extended writing task is scored on the Georgia Milestones three-trait, eight-point rubric:

Trait	Points	What earns the top score
Purpose and Organization	0 to 3	A clearly stated claim or controlling idea, a cohesive structure, a strong introduction and conclusion, transitions that create cohesion within and between paragraphs, a style that fits the audience
Evidence and Elaboration	0 to 3	Reasons that support the claim, evidence integrated from multiple sources, effective elaboration, consistent crediting of sources
Language Usage and Conventions	0 to 2	Varied sentence structures, mostly correct verb tense, mostly active voice, few errors that do not interfere with meaning

Three planning consequences:

- **Trait 2 rewards elaboration and source crediting, not evidence volume.** Three quotations with no explanation score a 1. Every unit from Unit 3 forward teaches the introduce, cite, explain move and the "according to the article" attribution move.
- **Trait 3 is exactly 7.L.GC.2.** Sentence variety, consistent verb tense, active voice. That standard is a priority standard in four units for that reason.
- **A response has to be long enough to show command.** Very brief responses cap Trait 3. Stamina is built through timed rehearsals, not through the summative.

3.2 SECTION-LEVEL WRITING TASKS

The ALDs describe Proficient performance on organization and techniques in terms of parts of texts, not only whole essays. The Proficient descriptor for 7.T.SS.1 names a complete introduction, a complete conclusion, transitions across two paragraphs, and supporting details in multiple sections. The full multi-paragraph text with varied transitions throughout is the Distinguished descriptor. That is a signal about item types. Plan for these as tasks in every unit, in instruction and on assessments:

- Craft a section of a text that guides the focus
- Revise part of an introduction to address the question, purpose, or audience; craft a complete introduction
- Use supporting facts, reasons, details, descriptions, or events to increase the focus in a section
- Revise part of a conclusion; craft a complete conclusion
- Add varied transition words and phrases across two paragraphs
- Given a claim, counterclaim, or reason, add another argumentative technique (a counterclaim, relevant evidence)
- Apply expository techniques within a paragraph: introduce the topic, develop it with a fact, statistic, or key detail, provide closure
- Sequence plot when given part of the sequence; use one instance of dialogue for a purpose; use a descriptive detail for a purpose
- Identify sentences that deviate from the formal or informal style appropriate to purpose and audience
- Use figurative language for an intentional effect in a section of text
- Determine when active voice should be used; determine when a misplaced or dangling modifier should be corrected
- Construct a word from a root and an affix; choose the precise word using parts of speech

3.3 NARRATIVE IS STILL TESTED

Narrative is not the extended writing task, but the 7.T.T.1 ALDs describe applying dialogue, descriptive details, and plot sequencing to achieve a purpose. Treat narrative as a constructed-response genre: a passage, then a prompt to continue the scene or retell from another point of view. Unit 2 builds it; Unit 7 revisits it.

3.4 WHICH GUM SKILLS ARE ON THE TEST

The 7.L.GC.1 ALD lists the grade 7 Master items and the items mastered in grades 5 and 6 that grade 7 reinforces. It does not list the Introduce or Continue items. So the tested conventions at grade 7 are:

Tested GUM skill	Code at grade 7
Commas, parentheses, and dashes to set off nonessential words, phrases, or clauses	M
Demonstrative pronouns	I, M
Correlative conjunctions	R
Capitalization, quotation marks, commas, end punctuation, and attributions for exact words and dialogue	R
Semicolons to separate items in a series when an item contains commas	R
Progressive, perfect, and perfect progressive verb aspects	R
Participles	R
Vague pronoun references	R
Intensive pronouns	R
Indefinite pronouns with correct agreement	R
Subordinating conjunctions to join clauses	R
Commas after introductory phrases or clauses	R
Capitalization, underlining, quotation marks, or italics for titles of works	R

The Introduce and Continue items (colons for lists, verbals by function, ellipses, hyphens with affixes and compounds, semicolons with conjunctive adverbs, sentence functions of phrases and clauses, citation punctuation) get taught because grade 8 masters them, but they are not where test-prep time goes.

3.5 ALD LEVELS AS THE SUCCESS-CRITERIA LADDER

The ALDs are the best available description of what Surface, Deep, and Transfer look like in writing at grade 7. Use them to fill the DOK columns of Stage 1.

Achievement level	Verbs the ALDs use	DOK	What it looks like in student writing
Beginning	identify, recognize, plan, use one	1	One technique, one transition, a plan for a text
Developing	describe, explain, apply one technique, revise part of	2	A paragraph; a section of a text; a revised introduction or conclusion
Proficient	analyze, apply multiple techniques across two paragraphs, craft a complete introduction or conclusion	3	Two developed paragraphs with techniques and transitions; a complete introduction or conclusion; a full plan
Distinguished	analyze across texts, apply throughout a text, apply in another genre	3 to 4	A coherent multi-paragraph text with techniques and transitions throughout; a narrative technique used inside an argument

In every unit below, the Surface column is the Beginning and Developing descriptors, the Deep column is the Proficient descriptor, and the Transfer column is the Distinguished descriptor. That keeps the ladder honest and keeps the target visible.

Caveat. These ALDs are marked draft and are subject to revision after standard setting. Confirm item counts and the DOK share in the current GaDOE Grade 7 ELA Assessment Guide and blueprint before entering a DOK distribution in Stage 2.

4. Year-long routines: the writing spine

These run in every unit. They are what make the unit plans satisfy the reading, writing, and discussion expectations without bolting anything on.

Routine	Frequency	What it is	Standards it carries
Sentence of the day	Daily, 8 to 10 min, alternating with quick write	Sentence imitation or sentence combining tied to the unit's GUM focus; students write, compare, and name the move	7.L.GC.1 , 7.L.GC.2.b , K-12.P.AC.2.c
Quick write to the text	Daily, 8 to 10 min, alternating with sentence work	A short response to the day's text or a craft prompt; low stakes, shared aloud	K-12.P.EICC.2 , K-12.P.EICC.4.c
Weekly constructed response	Weekly	One text-based paragraph scored 0 to 2 or 0 to 4 with feedback that names the rubric trait; returned within two days	7.T.SS.1.d , the unit's Techniques standard, 7.T.RA.2.c
Independent reading with notebook	Weekly	Self-selected text with a reading and writing notebook entry	K-12.P.EICC.1.c , K-12.P.EICC.3
Writing conference cycle	Every two weeks, 5 students per day, 4 to 5 minutes each	One trait focus per conference; the student names the next move	K-12.P.EICC.4.f , K-12.P.EICC.4.g
Named discussion protocol	At least three times per unit	Socratic seminar, fishbowl, Structured Academic Controversy, Save the Last Word, Says/Does, gallery walk, Philosophical Chairs	K-12.P.CP.1 , 7.T.C.2
Rubric and exemplar study	First third of every unit	Students score an exemplar and a weak sample with the unit rubric before they draft	K-12.P.EICC.4.f , K-12.P.AC.1
Timed rehearsal	At least twice per unit	Independent, in the summative's format and time; scored on the same rubric	The unit's priority writing standards
Portfolio	End of every unit	Summative plus a reflection against the unit's success criteria; used in goal conferences	K-12.P.EICC.1.a , K-12.P.EICC.1.b

Classroom language. Use the rubric trait names from August: Purpose and Organization, Evidence and Elaboration, Language Usage and Conventions. Feedback names the trait. Students self-assess by trait. By April the rubric is not new.

Vocabulary strand. Each unit carries four or five Greek and Latin roots tied to the unit's content and a Tier 2 academic list drawn from the mentor texts. Students construct words from roots and affixes (7.L.V.2.c) and keep a connotation ladder for word-choice decisions (7.L.V.3.c , 7.L.V.3.e). Vocabulary shows up in the writing, not on a Friday quiz alone.

5. Assessment calendar

Week	Assessment	Format	Scored with	Purpose
2	Baseline extended writing plus GUM diagnostic	Milestones format: one or two short sources, 45 minutes, argumentative or expository	3-trait rubric; item key for GUM	Baseline trait scores; goal setting; grouping
9	Unit 2: narrative retelling plus timed narrative constructed response	Process piece plus 30-minute passage-based CR	Narrative rubric built from the 7.T.T.1 ALD Proficient bullets	Unit summative
14	Unit 3: extended expository essay	Milestones format: paired sources, 90 minutes	3-trait rubric	Unit summative
18	Semester benchmark	District benchmark if scheduled; otherwise a Milestones-format mixed assessment with an extended task	3-trait rubric plus item key	Mid-year progress against baseline
25	Unit 5: extended argumentative essay	Milestones format: paired sources, 90 minutes	3-trait rubric	Unit summative
30	Unit 6: literary analysis essay plus poetry portfolio	Timed analysis essay plus portfolio with writer's note	3-trait rubric adapted for analysis; poetry rubric from the 7.T.T.4 ALD	Unit summative
32 to 33	Mock EOG	Full Milestones simulation: selected response, constructed response, extended writing	3-trait rubric plus item key	Trait-based small groups for the final two weeks
34 to 35	Georgia Milestones EOG	State	State	
36	Capstone and portfolio	Multimodal text plus reflection letter	Capstone rubric	Year-end evidence; goal conference

Four timed Milestones-format essays before the mock (weeks 2, 14, 18, 25) plus at least two rehearsals inside each of Units 3 and 5. That is the stamina plan.

6. Unit 1. Launch: A Community of Writers and Readers

Weeks 1 to 3 | 15 days | Quarter 1

Unit questions. What do writers actually do? Who am I as a writer, and what do I need this year?

Enduring understanding. Writing is a series of decisions, and purpose and audience drive every one of them. A writer who can name the decision can revise it.

STANDARDS

Role	Standard	In plain terms
Priority	K-12.P.EICC.1 (a, b, e, f)	Reader and writer identity: goals, preferences, community norms, independence
Priority	K-12.P.EICC.4 (a to h)	Writing process: purpose and audience, plan, generate, draft, evaluate, revise, edit
Priority	7.T.SS.1.d	Multi-paragraph text with an introduction that guides focus, support, and a conclusion (baseline)
Priority	7.L.GC.2.b	Simple, compound, complex, compound-complex sentences; consistent verb tense
Supporting	7.T.SS.2.c	Formal versus informal style by situation
Supporting	K-12.P.CP.1	Collaboration norms
Supporting	7.L.V.1.b	Academic vocabulary in writing

Language strand. Diagnostic on the Reinforce items (subject-verb agreement, pronoun-antecedent and indefinite pronoun agreement, commas after introductory elements, subordinating conjunctions, titles of works). Four sentence types. Fragments and run-ons. Demonstrative pronouns (**this** , **that** , **these** , **those** standing alone as pronouns, and the vague sentence-opening "This" that the Reinforce item on vague pronoun references targets). Roots: **graph** , **scrib/script** , **dict** , **voc** .

Learning targets (noun concepts). The writing process. Audience and purpose. Paragraph structure: focus, support, close. Sentence types. Writer identity and goals.

SUCCESS CRITERIA LADDER

Surface (DOK 1 to 2)	Deep (DOK 3)	Transfer (DOK 3 to 4)
Name the stages of the writing process and what each produces. Identify the audience and purpose of a mentor text. Classify sentences by type.	Explain how a mentor writer's choices fit purpose and audience. Revise a paragraph so the focus, support, and close cohere. Combine sentences using all four types without changing meaning.	Produce an on-demand text-based response with an introduction that guides the focus, support, and a conclusion. Set and justify personal writing goals from baseline trait scores.

STAGE 2: EVIDENCE

- **Summative.** Baseline extended writing in Milestones format (one or two short sources, 45 minutes, argumentative or expository), scored on the 3-trait rubric. Plus a writer's launch piece (a short personal essay or letter about the student as a writer, taken through the full process). Plus the GUM diagnostic. The baseline is not graded punitively. It sets goals and groups.
- **Formative checkpoints that mirror the summative.** A timed single-paragraph response to a short text in week 1. A paragraph revision task in week 2 (given a draft paragraph, fix focus, support, and close).
- **Independent rehearsals.** The week 1 timed paragraph and the week 2 baseline itself.
- **Rubric shown.** The 3-trait rubric introduced in week 2 with one strong and one weak sample scored as a class.

MENTOR TEXTS

Short pieces about writing and reading: an author interview or a short personal essay on why the author writes, a letter to a younger writer, a short anthology narrative used as a shared read. Keep them short. The text serves the writing.

STAGE 3: WEEKLY ARC

Week	Focus	Writing produced
1	Norms (chalk talk protocol), notebooks, writer identity survey, sentence-type diagnostic, first shared text	Quick writes; timed paragraph to a short text
2	Paragraph anatomy; introduce the 3-trait rubric with samples; baseline extended writing; GUM diagnostic	Baseline essay; paragraph revision task
3	Revision and editing habits on the launch piece; peer response protocol (Praise, Question, Polish); author's chair; goal conferences from baseline	Launch piece published; goals written

Discussion protocols. Chalk talk for norms. Save the Last Word for the shared text. Author's chair.

Relevancy. Students already make writing decisions every day in texts and captions. The unit names what they already do and puts a rubric on it.

Watch-outs. Do not spend three weeks on procedures. A real piece of writing comes out by day 7. The baseline has to be in Milestones format or it tells you nothing usable about trait scores. Score the baseline yourself with the 3-trait rubric; the trait pattern across the class sets the emphasis for Units 3 and 5.

7. Unit 2. Narrative Craft: Myths, Retellings, and the Tools of Story

Weeks 4 to 9 | 30 days | Quarter 1

Unit questions. How do writers use narrative techniques to shape what a reader feels and understands? Why do modern writers keep retelling old stories, and what changes when they do?

Enduring understanding. Narrative techniques (sequencing, dialogue, description, pacing, flashback, foreshadowing) are choices that develop plot, character, and setting toward a purpose. Theme is built, not stated.

STANDARDS

Role	Standard	In plain terms
Priority	7.T.T.1.e	Apply narrative techniques to enhance writing, engage audiences, achieve purposes
Priority	7.T.T.1.a , 7.T.T.1.b	Analyze how techniques develop plot, character, setting; analyze plot structure, conflict, narrative devices
Priority	7.T.T.1.c	Compare and contrast how themes are developed across texts
Priority	7.T.PM.1.a	Analyze myths and stories that modern writers adapted; identify features of style and theme
Priority	7.L.GC.2.b , 7.L.GC.2.d	Sentence variety with consistent verb tense; misplaced and dangling modifiers
Priority	7.T.SS.2.b	Figurative language, literary devices, connotative language for intentional effect
Supporting	7.T.SS.1.c	Transitions of time and sequence
Supporting	7.L.V.3.c , 7.L.V.3.e	Connotation in character and setting description
Supporting	K-12.P.AC.1 , K-12.P.AC.2 , K-12.P.EICC.2.a	Reading like a writer; writing like a reader; sharing real or imagined experiences

Language strand. Dialogue punctuation with attributions (R): taught in week 5, not week 9. Verb tense consistency across a narrative. Participles and participial phrases as description (the verbals Introduce item) paired directly with misplaced and dangling modifiers, because the participial phrase is where the dangling modifier lives. Ellipses (C) for trailing dialogue. Vague pronoun references (R) in multi-character scenes. Hyphenated compound modifiers (C): "a well-worn path." Roots: **chron** , **path** , **bene/mal** , **morph** .

Learning targets. Narrative techniques. Plot structure and conflict. Theme development. Adaptation and retelling. Sentence variety and tense. Modifiers.

SUCCESS CRITERIA LADDER

Surface (DOK 1 to 2)	Deep (DOK 3)	Transfer (DOK 3 to 4)
Identify narrative techniques and plot stages in a story. Identify the myth a modern text adapts and one element it kept. Identify tense shifts and misplaced modifiers in a draft.	Analyze how a technique develops character or setting in a section of text, with evidence. Describe how a theme is developed through events. Apply one technique (a line of dialogue, a descriptive detail) for a stated purpose. Revise a passage for tense consistency.	Write a narrative that sequences plot (exposition, rising action, climax, resolution) and uses dialogue and description for purpose. Compare theme development across the myth and its retelling with textual evidence. Use a narrative technique inside a non-narrative piece.

STAGE 2: EVIDENCE

- **Summative.** (1) Process piece: a modern retelling of a myth, or a narrative continuation from another character's point of view, two to four pages, full process, scored with a narrative rubric built from the **7.T.T.1** ALD Proficient bullets (clear sequence with climax and resolution, dialogue for purpose, descriptive details for purpose, consistent tense). (2) Timed

narrative constructed response from a passage, 30 minutes: continue the scene or retell from another point of view using dialogue and description. (3) Theme comparison constructed response on the myth and the retelling.

- **Formative checkpoints that mirror the summative.** Weekly "one scene, one technique" quick writes. Timed narrative CRs in weeks 6 and 8. Theme paragraph in week 7.
- **Independent rehearsals.** The week 6 and week 8 timed CRs.
- **Rubric shown.** Narrative rubric and an exemplar retelling in week 4; a weak sample scored in week 5.

MENTOR AND SOURCE TEXTS

Use district-adopted anthology stories first. Options that carry the standards: "Seventh Grade" (Gary Soto), "Thank You, M'am" (Langston Hughes), "Rikki-Tikki-Tavi" (Rudyard Kipling), "The Third Wish" (Joan Aiken), "Amigo Brothers" (Piri Thomas). Myth and adaptation pairs for 7.T.PM.1.a : "Daedalus and Icarus" with "Landscape with the Fall of Icarus" (William Carlos Williams) or a Percy Jackson excerpt; "Arachne" with a modern retelling; "Pandora"; "Echo and Narcissus." A myth collection (Hamilton or D'Aulaires excerpts) supplies the source myths.

STAGE 3: WEEKLY ARC

Week	Focus	Writing produced
4	Plot structure and sequencing; conflict; reading a short story with a plot map backed by evidence; rubric and exemplar	Quick writes; plot-map CR
5	Characterization through dialogue and description; dialogue punctuation with attributions; Says/Does protocol on a mentor passage	Dialogue scene; weekly CR on characterization
6	Setting; figurative language for mood; participial phrases and modifiers; first timed narrative CR	Setting paragraph; timed CR 1
7	Myths and retellings (7.T.PM.1.a); theme development compared across the pair; Socratic seminar	Theme comparison CR
8	Drafting the retelling; flashback and foreshadowing; pacing; second timed narrative CR	Full draft; timed CR 2
9	Revision for tense, sentence variety, modifiers; peer response; publish; author's chair; portfolio reflection	Final retelling; reflection

Discussion protocols. Says/Does on mentor passages. Socratic seminar on the myth pairing. Praise, Question, Polish for peer response. Author's chair.

Relevancy. Marvel, Percy Jackson, and most of Disney are retellings. Students diagnose what a retelling changes and why, then do it themselves.

Watch-outs. Narrative is where 7th grade writing time goes to die, and it is the least weighted writing on the EOG. Six weeks is the cap. Dialogue punctuation is the most common conventions error in narrative; front-load it. Do not let figurative language become simile hunting; the standard is effect on meaning, mood, and tone, and the success criteria say so.

8. Unit 3. Expository Writing from Sources

Weeks 10 to 14 | 25 days | Quarter 2

Unit questions. How do writers turn information into understanding for a reader? How do two writers on the same topic end up with different texts?

Enduring understanding. Expository writers commit to a main idea, support it with facts, statistics, and key details, organize with a structure fit to purpose, and close with a sense of closure. Two authors on one topic emphasize different evidence, and a reader can see it.

STANDARDS

Role	Standard	In plain terms
Priority	7.T.T.2.d	Apply expository techniques: main idea, facts, statistics, key details, text features, closure
Priority	7.T.T.2.a , 7.T.T.2.b	Analyze expository techniques; analyze how two authors on the same topic emphasize different evidence
Priority	7.T.SS.1.a , 7.T.SS.1.b	Analyze how authors modify structures; design texts with structures and features fit to purpose and audience
Priority	7.T.SS.1.c , 7.T.SS.1.d	Varied transitions across paragraphs; multi-paragraph text with introduction, support, conclusion
Priority	7.T.SS.2.c	Formal style by situation
Priority	7.T.C.1.a , 7.T.C.1.b	Multiple purposes in a text; text mode features that aid comprehension
Supporting	7.T.RA.2.a	Record source information (author, title, site, year)
Supporting	7.L.GC.2.c	Active voice
Supporting	K-12.P.AC.3	Text design

Language strand. Commas, parentheses, and dashes to set off nonessential elements: this is the grade 7 Master item, and the appositive is the entry point ("The Altamaha, the largest free-flowing river in Georgia, ..."). Semicolons in a series that contains commas (R). Colons to introduce lists and examples (I). Hyphens in compound words (C). Titles of works (R) when naming sources. Subordinating conjunctions for cause and effect (R). Roots: **struct** , **port** , **spec** , **form** .

Learning targets. Main idea and support. Text structures: compare and contrast, cause and effect, problem and solution, description, sequence. Transitions. Introductions and conclusions. Formal style. Text features.

SUCCESS CRITERIA LADDER

Surface (DOK 1 to 2)	Deep (DOK 3)	Transfer (DOK 3 to 4)
Identify a main idea and the facts that support it. Identify a text's structure and its signal words. Identify transitions. Classify sentences as formal or informal.	Explain how two authors shape the same topic differently, with evidence from both. Apply expository techniques within a paragraph: topic sentence, fact or statistic, key detail, closure. Craft a complete introduction, or revise a conclusion, for a provided draft. Add varied transitions across two paragraphs.	Write a multi-paragraph expository essay from two sources with a coherent structure chosen for the purpose, an introduction that guides the focus, supported body paragraphs, a conclusion, and consistent formal style. Design a text with features that serve the reader.

STAGE 2: EVIDENCE

- **Summative.** Milestones-format extended expository essay from two paired informational texts, 90 minutes, on demand in week 14, scored on the 3-trait rubric. Plus an earlier process piece: a field-guide article with text features (headings, captions, a chart or sidebar) on a coastal Georgia topic (marsh ecosystems, the Altamaha, Sapelo Island and Hog

Hammock, Darien's shrimping fleet), for 7.T.SS.1.b and K-12.P.AC.3 . Plus a paired-source selected-response and constructed-response set for 7.T.T.2.b .

- **Formative checkpoints that mirror the summative.** Weekly section-level tasks: introduction only, conclusion only, transitions across two given paragraphs, insert a statistic and elaborate. One full timed essay in week 12, scored and conferenced.
- **Independent rehearsals.** The week 12 timed essay and the week 14 summative.
- **Rubric shown.** 3-trait rubric with an expository exemplar and a weak sample in week 10.

MENTOR AND SOURCE TEXTS

Paired informational texts from the anthology, CommonLit paired texts, Newsela text sets, and GaDOE released Milestones paired passages. Local sources: Georgia DNR coastal articles, Sapelo Island NERR materials. Two texts on one topic is the unit's reading shape, because 7.T.T.2.b requires it and the extended writing task is built on it.

STAGE 3: WEEKLY ARC

Week	Focus	Writing produced
10	What expository writing does; main idea and support; annotate mentor texts for techniques; rubric and exemplar	Weekly CR: paragraph applying expository techniques
11	Text structures and transitions; write body paragraphs from a source; appositives and nonessential elements	Two body paragraphs; transition task
12	Introductions and conclusions; two authors on the same topic (7.T.T.2.b); fishbowl; first full timed essay	Timed essay 1
13	Field-guide article with text features; formal style; colons and semicolons; jigsaw of local sources	Field-guide draft and revision
14	Revise the timed essay against the rubric; conference; summative on-demand essay; portfolio reflection	Summative essay; reflection

Discussion protocols. Jigsaw for text sets. Fishbowl on "which author's evidence did more work." Gallery walk of field guides.

Relevancy. Expository writing is most of what adults actually write: reports, explanations, instructions. The field guide has a real reader.

Watch-outs. The five-paragraph template produces a Trait 1 score of 2, not 3. The standard says "flexibly employing a variety of text structures." Teach structure as a choice. Students will copy from sources; teach paraphrase and the attribution move now, because Trait 2 rewards crediting sources and Unit 4 formalizes citation.

9. Unit 4. Research, Credibility, and Multimodal Presentation

Weeks 15 to 18 | 20 days | Quarter 2

Unit questions. How do I find out what is true, and how do I show my reader where it came from?

Enduring understanding. Research begins with questions, depends on credible sources, and requires giving credit in a standard format. The mode of presentation changes how information lands.

STANDARDS

Role	Standard	In plain terms
Priority	7.T.RA.1.a , 7.T.RA.1.b , 7.T.RA.1.c	Generate research questions; locate, gather, curate, integrate information from credible sources; use research to support, challenge, or extend ideas
Priority	7.T.RA.2.a , 7.T.RA.2.b , 7.T.RA.2.c	Record bibliographic information; analyze credibility and relevance; standard citation format with a works cited page
Priority	7.T.C.2.d	Use credible sources to research answers to questions
Priority	7.T.C.1.c	Construct multimodal texts or presentations with clearly identifiable features of multiple modes
Priority	K-12.P.CP.2	Presentation skills for a target audience
Supporting	7.T.T.2.d , 7.T.SS.1.b	Expository techniques and structure in the report
Supporting	7.L.V.3.d	Print and digital reference tools
Supporting	7.T.C.2.b	Evidence and tone and their effect on credibility

Language strand. Punctuation and parentheses with citations when incorporating textual evidence (C). Titles of works (R): quotation marks for articles, italics for sites and books. Active voice in reporting (7.L.GC.2.c). Nonessential elements (M) continue, now as source attribution. Roots: cred , vid/vis , ver , log .

Learning targets. Research questions. Source credibility and relevance. Note-taking and paraphrase. In-text citation and works cited (MLA). Integrating evidence. Multimodal design.

SUCCESS CRITERIA LADDER

Surface (DOK 1 to 2)	Deep (DOK 3)	Transfer (DOK 3 to 4)
Generate a research question. Identify a credible source for a provided topic. Record author, title, site, and year. Recognize a basic in-text citation.	Explain why a source is or is not credible and relevant to the question, with specifics. Paraphrase and quote with a standard in-text citation. Build a correct works cited entry from a source.	Conduct research from multiple credible sources to answer a question and produce a short research text plus a multimodal presentation with features of at least two modes. Use research to challenge or extend an idea from a text.

STAGE 2: EVIDENCE

- **Summative.** Short research report (three or four paragraphs, two or three sources, in-text citations, works cited) plus a three-minute multimodal presentation (slides, infographic, or short video with clearly identifiable features of two modes). Semester benchmark in week 18: the district benchmark if scheduled, otherwise a Milestones-format mixed assessment with an extended expository task.
- **Formative checkpoints that mirror the summative.** Credibility sort with written justification (week 15). Research paragraph with citation (week 16). Presentation rehearsal with a two-question feedback protocol (week 17).
- **Independent rehearsals.** The week 16 research paragraph and the week 18 benchmark.
- **Rubric shown.** Report and presentation rubric with a model report in week 15.

TOPIC CHOICE

A question that grows from Unit 2 or Unit 3 ("How accurate is the setting of the story we read?" or a follow-up to the field guide), or a local history question: Sapelo Island and Hog Hammock, Fort King George, Darien's timber era, the Altamaha. Local questions are real, students have stake in them, and sources exist.

STAGE 3: WEEKLY ARC

Week	Focus	Writing produced
15	Questions and source hunt; credibility and relevance; source speed-dating protocol	Research questions; credibility sort with justification
16	Notes, paraphrase, plagiarism; MLA in-text citation and works cited	Research paragraph with citation
17	Draft the report; build the presentation (two days, not two weeks); rehearsal	Report draft; presentation
18	Present; semester benchmark; portfolio reflection	Final report; benchmark

Discussion protocols. Source speed-dating (partners trade sources and vet them). Two-question presentation feedback.

Relevancy. Everyone researches. Most do it badly, from the first search result. Credibility is a life skill and the students know it.

Watch-outs. Keep the product short. Four weeks with a benchmark week is tight. Do not let this become a three-week slideshow unit; the writing standards are the point, and the slides get two days. Pick one citation format (MLA) and use it all year, including in Units 5 and 6.

10. Unit 5. Argumentative Writing from Sources

Weeks 19 to 25 | 35 days | Quarter 3

Unit questions. What makes an argument worth believing? How do I answer the other side without losing my own?

Enduring understanding. An argument advances a claim with reasons and relevant evidence, acknowledges a counterclaim and answers it, and ends with a conclusion that follows logically. Perspective, tone, and evidence decide whether a reader trusts the writer.

STANDARDS

Role	Standard	In plain terms
Priority	7.T.T.3.c	Apply argumentative techniques: claim, relevant evidence, counterclaim, logical conclusion
Priority	7.T.T.3.a	Analyze argumentative techniques in texts
Priority	7.T.C.2.a , 7.T.C.2.b	Determine the prevailing perspective; analyze how evidence and tone reveal perspective and affect credibility
Priority	7.T.SS.1.c , 7.T.SS.1.d	Transitions across paragraphs; multi-paragraph structure
Priority	7.L.GC.2.b , 7.L.GC.2.c	Sentence variety with consistent tense; active voice
Priority	7.T.RA.2.c	Cite integrated evidence in a standard format
Supporting	7.T.C.2.c	Context and its effect on a text
Supporting	7.T.SS.2.c	Formal style
Supporting	7.L.V.3.c , 7.L.V.3.e	Connotation; loaded language
Supporting	K-12.P.ST.2	Author, audience, and purpose

Language strand. Correlative conjunctions (R) for framing claim and counterclaim: "not only ... but also," "either ... or," "whether ... or." Subordinating conjunctions with introductory commas (R) for concession: "Although the article claims ..., ...". Semicolons with conjunctive adverbs (C): "however," "therefore," "consequently." Indefinite pronoun agreement (R): the "everyone ... their" trap. Active voice (7.L.GC.2.c) as a revision move. Nonessential elements (M) for attribution: "The author, a pediatrician who has studied screen time, argues ...". Roots: **fid** , **jud/jur** , **contra** , **ver** .

Learning targets. Claim. Reasons and relevant evidence. Counterclaim and rebuttal. Logical conclusion. Author's perspective, tone, and credibility. Argumentative structure.

SUCCESS CRITERIA LADDER

Surface (DOK 1 to 2)	Deep (DOK 3)	Transfer (DOK 3 to 4)
Identify the claim, a piece of evidence, and the counterclaim in an argument. Identify a text's prevailing perspective. Classify sentences as active or passive.	Explain how evidence and tone reveal an author's perspective and affect credibility, with evidence. Given a claim, write a counterclaim paragraph with a rebuttal. Given a reason, add relevant evidence and elaborate on it. Write a conclusion that follows logically from a provided argument. Revise passive sentences to active.	Write a multi-paragraph argument from two sources with a claim, reasons, cited evidence with elaboration, an addressed counterclaim, and a conclusion that follows. Analyze two authors' perspectives on the same issue and judge which is more credible.

STAGE 2: EVIDENCE

- **Summative.** Milestones-format extended argumentative essay from paired sources, 90 minutes, on demand in week 25, scored on the 3-trait rubric. Plus a process argument for a real audience (letter to the principal, school board, or county

commission, or an op-ed) taken through revision. Plus a perspective and credibility constructed response on two authors (7.T.C.2.b).

- **Formative checkpoints that mirror the summative.** Section-level tasks weekly: claim and reasons only; counterclaim paragraph only; conclusion only; evidence and elaboration for a given reason. Timed essays in weeks 21 and 23, each scored on the rubric and conferenced.
- **Independent rehearsals.** The week 21 and week 23 timed essays.
- **Rubric shown.** Argument exemplar and weak sample scored in week 19; anonymized student essays from prior years for calibration in week 23.

MENTOR AND SOURCE TEXTS

Argumentative pairs from CommonLit, Newsela, and GaDOE released Milestones passages. Speeches: Malala Yousafzai's UN address, Severn Cullis-Suzuki's Rio address. For 7.T.C.2.b , an op-ed and a news report on the same issue. Issues students have a stake in: phone policies, dress code, start times, year-round school, a county issue.

STAGE 3: WEEKLY ARC

Week	Focus	Writing produced
19	Anatomy of an argument: claim, reasons, evidence; map two arguments; rubric and exemplar	Argument map CR; claim-and-reasons task
20	Evidence selection and elaboration (introduce, cite, explain); citing sources; Philosophical Chairs	Body paragraph with cited, elaborated evidence
21	Counterclaim and rebuttal; concession syntax; correlative and subordinating conjunctions; first timed essay	Counterclaim paragraph; timed essay 1
22	Perspective, tone, and credibility (7.T.C.2); loaded language; Structured Academic Controversy	Perspective and credibility CR
23	Introductions and conclusions for arguments; second timed essay scored and conferenced; calibration with student samples	Timed essay 2
24	Real-audience process argument; revision for active voice and sentence variety; peer review with the rubric	Letter or op-ed, revised
25	Summative on-demand essay; portfolio reflection	Summative essay; reflection

Discussion protocols. Structured Academic Controversy. Philosophical Chairs. Four Corners. Rubric-based peer review.

Relevancy. Arguments decide the things students argue about anyway. The real-audience piece goes to a real audience.

Watch-outs. Counterclaim is where 7th graders collapse. They state it and never answer it, or they answer by insulting it. Teach the concession sentence explicitly and require the rebuttal. Trait 2 rewards elaboration, not evidence volume; push "so what" after every citation. Score at least two timed essays with the actual Milestones rubric before the summative, and give the trait scores back to students.

11. Unit 6. Literary Analysis and Poetry: Theme, Time, and Craft

Weeks 26 to 30 | 25 days | Quarters 3 and 4

Unit questions. How do writers from a particular time and place craft meaning, and how do I write about it? What can a poem do that prose cannot?

Enduring understanding. Literature carries the marks of its period. Theme is built through characters, events, and structure, and comparing texts sharpens what each one means. Poets use sound, image, and structure for effect, and so can students.

STANDARDS

Role	Standard	In plain terms
Priority	7.T.T.4.a , 7.T.T.4.b	Analyze poetic techniques; apply them to produce poetry
Priority	7.T.T.1.c	Compare and contrast theme development across texts
Priority	7.T.T.1.d	Compare a fictional portrayal with a historical account of the same period
Priority	7.T.PM.1.b	Analyze one genre of literature from a time period; features of style and theme
Priority	7.T.SS.2.a , 7.T.SS.2.b	Explain how figurative and connotative language contribute to meaning, mood, tone; use them for effect
Priority	7.T.C.2.c	Impact of era, place, and events on text development
Priority	7.T.T.2.d	Expository techniques applied to analytical writing
Supporting	7.L.V.3.b , 7.L.V.3.c	Word relationships; connotation
Supporting	K-12.P.AC.1 , K-12.P.CP.2.e	Reading like a writer; reciting poems
Supporting	7.T.SS.1.d	Multi-paragraph structure

Language strand. Verbals by function (I): gerunds and infinitives alongside participles, because poems and analytical sentences are full of them. Progressive, perfect, and perfect progressive aspects (R) in the literary present. Intensive pronouns (R). Punctuation with textual evidence and citations (C). Titles of works (R): poem titles in quotation marks, book titles in italics. Roots: **phon** , **son** , **lum/luc** , **tempor** .

Learning targets. Theme development. Poetic techniques: stanza, rhyme scheme, imagery, figurative language, sound devices. Literary period. Historical context and fiction. Literary analysis structure. Textual evidence and citation.

SUCCESS CRITERIA LADDER

Surface (DOK 1 to 2)	Deep (DOK 3)	Transfer (DOK 3 to 4)
Identify poetic techniques in a poem. Identify a theme. Identify a historical detail in fiction that matches an account. Identify key features of a period's style.	Explain how a technique contributes to meaning, mood, or tone, with evidence. Describe how a theme is developed through events. Compare a fictional portrayal with a historical account. Apply a poetic technique in an original poem for a stated effect.	Write a literary analysis essay comparing how two texts develop a theme, with cited evidence and explanation. Produce a poem using multiple techniques for effect, with a writer's note explaining the choices. Analyze how a period's context shapes a text.

STAGE 2: EVIDENCE

- **Summative.** (1) Literary analysis essay comparing theme development across two texts (a poem and a story, or a novel and a historical account), timed, scored on the 3-trait rubric adapted for analysis (controlling idea in place of claim). (2) Poetry portfolio: three poems using multiple techniques plus a writer's note, and a recitation (**K-12.P.CP.2.e**).

- **Formative checkpoints that mirror the summative.** Technique-and-effect CRs weekly. Theme comparison paragraph (week 28). Fiction-versus-history CR (week 28). Poem drafts with a technique checklist. Timed analysis rehearsal (week 29).
- **Independent rehearsals.** The week 29 timed rehearsal and the week 30 summative.
- **Rubric shown.** Analysis exemplar in week 26; poetry rubric with a model poem and writer's note in week 26.

TEXTS

Period option A: Harlem Renaissance poetry as the genre from a time period (7.T.PM.1.b): Langston Hughes ("Harlem," "Mother to Son," "I, Too"), Countee Cullen, James Weldon Johnson, paired with a short historical account of the Great Migration, which began in Georgia and ties to 7.T.C.2.c . Period option B: a historical novel with a historical pairing for 7.T.T.1.d : "A Long Walk to Water" with news accounts of the Lost Boys of Sudan, or excerpts from "Roll of Thunder, Hear My Cry" with an account of 1930s Mississippi. Additional poems for technique: Frost, Dickinson, Angelou's "Still I Rise," Naomi Shihab Nye, Poe's "Annabel Lee."

STAGE 3: WEEKLY ARC

Week	Focus	Writing produced
26	Poetic techniques through reading; sound and image; imitation poems; rubrics and exemplars	Technique-and-effect CR; imitation poem
27	Period study: context, features of style and theme (7.T.PM.1.b , 7.T.C.2.c); Socratic seminar	Period features CR; poem 2
28	Fiction and historical account; theme development across texts	Fiction-versus-history CR; theme comparison paragraph
29	Writing about literature: literary present, embedded evidence, citation; timed analysis rehearsal; conference	Timed rehearsal; revision
30	Poetry portfolio finishing and recitation; summative analysis essay; portfolio reflection	Summative essay; portfolio

Discussion protocols. Socratic seminar on the poems. Poetry read-around. Save the Last Word. Analysis peer review.

Relevancy. Music is poetry and students already analyze lyrics. The period study is Georgia history.

Watch-outs. Poetry writing can eat the unit. Hold it to about forty percent of the days. The analysis essay is expository technique applied to literature, which is Milestones-relevant, and it gets the time. Fiction versus historical account (7.T.T.1.d) is a listed grade 7 expectation that is easy to skip. It is here on purpose.

12. Unit 7. Milestones Writing Intensive

Weeks 31 to 33 | 15 days | Quarter 4

Unit question. How do I show what I can do as a writer under test conditions?

Enduring understanding. The EOG samples the year. Writers who can name the trait can fix the draft.

STANDARDS

Role	Standard	In plain terms
Priority	7.T.T.2.d , 7.T.T.3.c	Expository and argumentative techniques on demand
Priority	7.T.SS.1.b , 7.T.SS.1.c , 7.T.SS.1.d	Structure, transitions, complete texts and sections of texts
Priority	7.L.GC.1 (tested R and M items), 7.L.GC.2.b , 7.L.GC.2.c , 7.L.GC.2.d	Conventions, sentence variety, active voice, modifiers in revision items
Priority	7.T.T.1.e	Narrative constructed response

No new content. Every day includes real writing scored against the rubric with feedback that names the trait.

STAGE 3: DAILY ARC

Days	Focus	Writing produced
1 to 3	Expository cycle: section-level tasks (introduction, transitions, conclusion), then a full timed essay	Timed expository essay
4 to 6	Argumentative cycle: counterclaim and elaboration tasks, then a full timed essay	Timed argumentative essay
7 to 8	Narrative constructed response from a passage; dialogue and description for purpose	Timed narrative CR
9 to 10	Revision and editing in Milestones item formats: best transition, fix the modifier, punctuate the appositive, active voice, tense consistency, sentence combining	Item sets
11 to 12	Full mock EOG, including the extended writing task, scored by trait	Mock EOG
13 to 15	Trait-based small groups from mock scores; pacing plan (plan 5, draft 40, revise 10)	Targeted revision

Assessment. The mock EOG in days 11 and 12. An AI-scored writing simulation with trait feedback, if one is built for grade 7, gets every student a trait score overnight.

Watch-outs. Do not run three weeks of packets. Do not skip narrative because it is not the extended task; the ALDs test it as a constructed response. Students who score 1 on Trait 2 need elaboration practice, not more grammar.

13. Weeks 34 to 36. EOG window and Capstone

Weeks 34 and 35: EOG testing. Light writing on non-testing days: notebook, independent reading, portfolio curation.

Week 36 and remaining days: Capstone. A multimodal text on a topic of the student's choice in any genre studied this year (podcast segment, photo essay, zine, PSA, short documentary script), for 7.T.C.1.c , K-12.P.AC.3.d , and K-12.P.CP.2 . A portfolio reflection letter that revisits the August goals against the baseline and the mock scores (K-12.P.EICC.1.a , K-12.P.EICC.1.b). Grade 8 bridge in sentence-of-the-day: colons to introduce quotations, dashes, tenses and aspects for verb mood, and using a style guide, which are the grade 8 Introduce items.

14. Standards coverage matrix

P is a priority standard in that unit's Stage 1. S is supporting, carried by routines. Every grade 7 expectation in the standards document appears at least once.

LANGUAGE DOMAIN

Expectation	U1	U2	U3	U4	U5	U6	U7	Cap
7.L.GC.1 GUM (see section 15 for placement by skill)	P	S	S	S	S	S	P	S
7.L.GC.2.a Syntax to comprehend texts		S			S	S		
7.L.GC.2.b Sentence variety, consistent tense	P	P	S		P	S	P	
7.L.GC.2.c Active voice			S	S	P		P	
7.L.GC.2.d Misplaced and dangling modifiers		P			S		P	
7.L.V.1.a , 7.L.V.1.b Vocabulary acquisition and use	S	S	S	S	S	S		S
7.L.V.2.a to 7.L.V.2.d Word analysis and construction	S	S	S	S	S	S		
7.L.V.3.b Word relationships						S		
7.L.V.3.c Connotation		S			S	S		
7.L.V.3.d Reference tools				S				
7.L.V.3.e Nuanced word choice in writing		S			S	S		

TEXTS DOMAIN

Expectation	U1	U2	U3	U4	U5	U6	U7	Cap
7.T.C.1.a Multiple purposes in a text			P					
7.T.C.1.b Text mode features			P					
7.T.C.1.c Multimodal texts for purpose and audience				P				P
7.T.C.2.a Prevailing perspective					P			
7.T.C.2.b Evidence, tone, credibility				S	P			
7.T.C.2.c Context and text development					S	P		
7.T.C.2.d Credible sources for research				P				
7.T.SS.1.a Analyze modified structures			P					
7.T.SS.1.b Design texts with structures and features			P	S			P	
7.T.SS.1.c Varied transitions		S	P		P		P	
7.T.SS.1.d Multi-paragraph texts	P		P		P	S	P	
7.T.SS.2.a Explain figurative and connotative language		S				P		
7.T.SS.2.b Use figurative language for effect		P				P		
7.T.SS.2.c Formal and informal style	S		P		S			
7.T.T.1.a Narrative techniques across a text		P						

Expectation	U1	U2	U3	U4	U5	U6	U7	Cap
7.T.T.1.b Plot structure, conflict, devices		P						
7.T.T.1.c Compare theme development		P				P		
7.T.T.1.d Fiction versus historical account						P		
7.T.T.1.e Apply narrative techniques		P					P	
7.T.T.2.a Analyze expository techniques			P					
7.T.T.2.b Two authors, same topic			P					
7.T.T.2.d Apply expository techniques			P	S		P	P	
7.T.T.3.a Analyze argumentative techniques					P			
7.T.T.3.c Apply argumentative techniques					P		P	
7.T.T.4.a Analyze poetic techniques						P		
7.T.T.4.b Produce poetry						P		
7.T.RA.1.a to 7.T.RA.1.c Research and inquiry				P				
7.T.RA.2.a Record bibliographic information			S	P				
7.T.RA.2.b Credibility and relevance				P				
7.T.RA.2.c Standard citation and works cited				P	P	S		
7.T.PM.1.a Myths adapted by modern writers		P						
7.T.PM.1.b A genre from a time period						P		

PRACTICES DOMAIN

Standard	Where it lives
K-12.P.EICC.1 Reader and writer identity	Priority in Unit 1 and the Capstone; portfolio reflections every unit
K-12.P.EICC.2 Engagement and intention	Every unit through the genre's purpose (tell, inform, explain, analyze, influence)
K-12.P.EICC.3 Comprehension strategies	Every unit through mentor and source text reading
K-12.P.EICC.4 Writing processes	Priority in Unit 1; every process piece thereafter
K-12.P.ST.1 Context	Unit 6
K-12.P.ST.2 Author, audience, purpose	Unit 5; every rubric study
K-12.P.AC.1 Reading like a writer	Every mentor text study; Says/Does protocol
K-12.P.AC.2 Writing like a reader	Every revision cycle
K-12.P.AC.3 Text design	Units 3, 4, and Capstone
K-12.P.CP.1 Collaboration	Every named protocol
K-12.P.CP.2 Presentation	Unit 4 presentation; Unit 6 recitation; Capstone

15. Grade 7 GUM placement

Every grade 7 skill on the GUM chart with its code and where it is taught. Reinforce and Master items are the tested set.

GUM skill	Code at 7	Taught	Tested
Commas, parentheses, dashes for nonessential elements	M	Unit 3 (appositives), Units 4 and 5 (attribution), Unit 7 review	Yes
Demonstrative pronouns	I, M	Unit 1, Unit 7 review	Yes
Correlative conjunctions	R	Unit 5	Yes
Dialogue punctuation with attributions	R	Unit 2	Yes
Semicolons in a series containing commas	R	Unit 3	Yes
Progressive, perfect, perfect progressive aspects	R	Unit 6 (literary present), Unit 2 (tense consistency)	Yes
Participles	R	Unit 2	Yes
Vague pronoun references	R	Unit 1, Unit 2	Yes
Intensive pronouns	R	Unit 6	Yes
Indefinite pronoun agreement	R	Unit 1 diagnostic, Unit 5	Yes
Subordinating conjunctions	R	Unit 1 diagnostic, Unit 3, Unit 5	Yes
Commas after introductory phrases and clauses	R	Unit 1 diagnostic, Unit 5	Yes
Titles of works	R	Units 3, 4, 6	Yes
Colons to introduce lists, examples, explanations	I	Unit 3	No
Verbals and verbal phrases by function	I	Unit 2 (participles), Unit 6 (gerunds, infinitives)	No
Ellipses	C	Unit 2	No
Hyphens with affixes and compound words	C	Units 2 and 3	No
Semicolons with or without conjunctive adverbs	C	Unit 5	No
Parts of speech and phrases or clauses performing sentence functions	C	Sentence of the day, all year	No
Punctuation and parentheses with citations of textual evidence	C	Units 4, 5, 6	No

Grade 8 Introduce items previewed in the Capstone weeks: colons to introduce quotations, dashes, tenses and aspects for verb mood, using a style guide.

16. Unit plan checklist: the three lenses

What each unit plan built from this map needs to contain. This is the district's frame (backward design, reading and writing across the curriculum, rigor), applied to a writing classroom.

Backward design

- Stage 1 lists the unit's priority standards from this map and nothing else. Supporting standards live in the routines.
- The summative is built and linked before Stage 3 is written. It is the task named in this map.
- Every priority standard is assessed by at least three items or by a rubric row on the summative.
- At least two formative checkpoints use the summative's format and demand (the section-level tasks and the timed rehearsals).
- The rubric and an exemplar are shown and scored with students in the first third of the unit.
- Students perform the summative task type independently, in its format and timing, at least twice before the summative.
- Instructional days per standard roughly track the standard's weight on the summative.

Reading and writing across the curriculum

- Students read connected authentic text on at least half the days. In this map that is the mentor and source text.
- Students write connected prose (more than a phrase) on at least half the days. The daily routine plus the weekly CR gets there.
- A named discussion protocol appears at least three times.
- At least half the student tasks require constructing, explaining, analyzing, or arguing rather than selecting, matching, or labeling.
- Tasks require textual evidence and explain it.

Rigor

- Success criteria fill Surface, Deep, and Transfer and escalate. Use the ALD ladder in section 3.5.
- The highest instructional verb for each standard matches the standard's verb (analyze, apply, compare) before the assessment does.
- The DOK ceiling rises from the first third of the unit to the last third and reaches 3.
- Students generate and defend reasoning: peer review with the rubric, seminar, self-assessment against success criteria.
- Daily reflection is tied to that day's success criteria.

Also

- Learning targets are written as noun concepts (the writing process, counterclaim, theme development), not as activities.
- Relevancy is stated per standard and names this unit's content.
- If the section is co-taught or carries an SWD roster, SDI is tied to the day's task.

17. Direct notes for the teacher

- **Argument and expository come before the test, and they get the most days.** That is the extended writing task. Narrative gets six weeks and no more.
- **Section-level tasks are not a warm-up.** They are how Proficient is described in the ALDs. Put them on assessments.
- **Four timed Milestones-format essays before the mock.** Weeks 2, 14, 18, and 25. Score every one with the 3-trait rubric and give the trait scores back.
- **Conventions instruction goes to the tested set.** Thirteen skills, listed in section 3.4. Sentence of the day carries them. Grammar packets do not.
- **Trait 2 is elaboration.** If the class trait pattern on the baseline is low Trait 2, every unit from 3 forward leans on introduce, cite, explain.
- **One rubric language all year.** Purpose and Organization. Evidence and Elaboration. Language Usage and Conventions. By April it is not new.

Sources: Georgia's K-12 ELA Standards, 7th Grade (approved May 2023) and the Georgia Milestones Grade 7 ELA Achievement Level Descriptors (draft, October 2025, effective 2025-2026). Source of truth is 7th_Grade_ELA_Curriculum_Map.md in the curriculum repository.